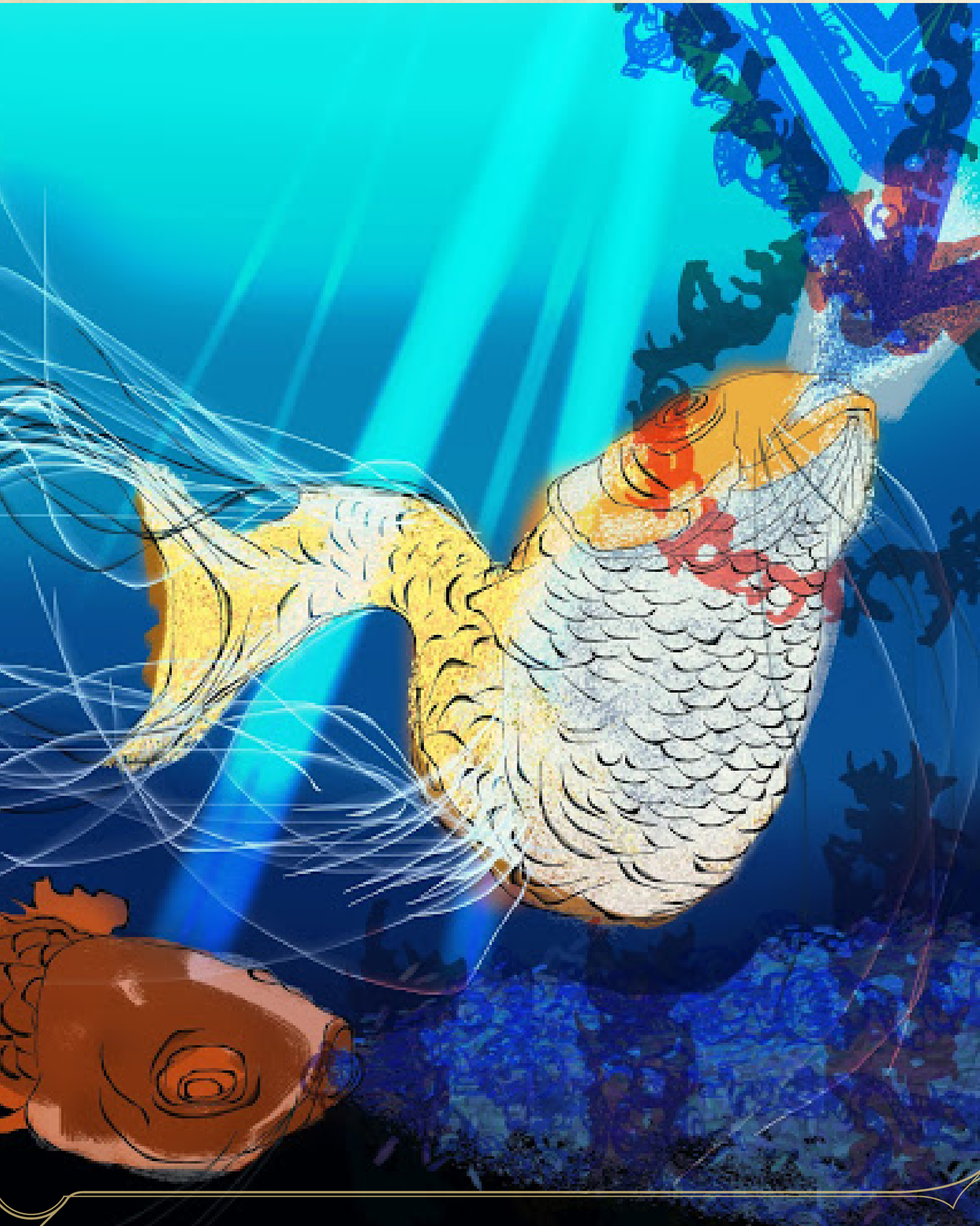

D&D
ARCANIA
LIBERTY ABOVE ALL
DUNGEONS & DRAGONS



This document represents the story telling of four seperate DMs. Not only is it meant to help equip you and orient you to our world. It is also meant to help inform you about the very different playstyles your DM's will be presenting.

The story of worlds, both Old and New.

The Old world (Everything in the Eastern Hemisphere of real world geography) is the domain of the Gods. All Gods great and small have dominion over their land, their people and their religions. There is no escape from the impact this has on daily life in the Old World. The God's feed on the faith and offerings of their devoted. Each of them embodying a different aspect of life, or championing their many conflicting causes.

Finding your place in the worlds:

As to the specific gods, our game concerns many pantheons of gods, including our Gods of the Round Table and their dominion of England. More information can be found here. Other countries may be referenced, but for the time being this is an unwritten blank space for you to apply your imagination and research. The writing that exists in the game pulls from a wide variety of folklore (from the huldufolk of Icelandic Myth, to the Myths and legends of the Hermetic faiths that point to Egypt as their fictional backdrop. In other cases, our DM's have free reign to use any assets (including pantheons) that are published by WOTC in their game crafting and lore that pertains to the stories they tell. Because we are writing collectively, the lore of Arcania can be amorphous and fluid at times. Speak to your DM about any ideas you might have about where your Character might be from, and what sort of folklore you may wish to adapt. Hopefully future iterations of the game will have more choices than just England.

There is a single narrative that weaves the fates of the Old World and the New World. This narrative is the story of the two brothers who founded the Occult traditions, The Golden Dawn and The Freemasons. They represent two ways to change the world. Hiram champions forethought and planning, and the magic of his Freemasons equate to having empathy for the struggles of those around you. The Golden Dawn represents a reactionary world. A world obsessed with outrage and entitlement. Solomon is selfish and lazy. He is a petty immortal charlatan who still pines for his brother Hiram's throne, despite the kingdom of the Brunelocks falling beneath the sands of the Sahara well over 1000 years ago.

Coming to Arcania

The setting is in the first half of the 17th century. Nearly 100 years since Christopher Columbus stole the secrets to accessing the New World from a group of Masonic Vikings known as the Roseline Temple. Along with the other members of Roseline Temple, the First Arcanian Cryptid to set foot on the shores of The Old World was a Sasquatch named Bigfoot. He, along with the Roseline Temple leaders Hiram Abiff, the half Orc Pym "of the Rosecutter", and many more of their ranks worked with the Wardens of the New World (of the Continent Arcania) Columbia, Cascadia, Fontaine And Oro to build a barrier between the two locations to prevent the Gods of the Old World from dominating the New World.

Despite the fact that roughly one third of the Gods are aligned to the ideas of good and benevolence, two thirds are either indifferent, or have dominating designs for the lesser beings beneath them. The dangers outweighed the possible benefits of opening their shores to the Cleric, Paladins and Warlocks of the Old World.

The New world (Everything in the Western Hemisphere of real world geography) is the home of Arcane magic. While Arcane magic is used around the world, it is pristine and unfettered by the will of the Gods of the Old World. Leylines carry Arcane magic from its source in Arcania to all other locations in the world. And this causes a subtle pull on all spell casters to journey to its source. The search for the point of origin for the nexus of all arcane magical power is called the search for the NorthWest Passage, and is the obsession of many Wizards, Sorcerers and other types of Arcane Casters.

Colonialism in the Worlds both Old and New.

Your reasons for traveling to the New World are yours and yours alone. Understanding your "coming to America" story starts with an understanding of the people who actually came here. It represents change. Change that can be either carefully thought out with good intentions and considerations for those around you, or change that can be brutal, violent and scar your heart. In this fantasy remimaging of early American History, you are what you bring with you from the Old World. Or in the case of a Native Race, you are left with the choice of how to deal with those who have come. This is not intended to follow history. It is intended to give you the chance to imagine being at the beginning of a new civilization. The conflicts you have in the game, and the resolutions you make are likely to inform the shape of the games to come.

Secret Societies.

As a player option, There are 4 secret societies in the world that play a function in how quests and (sometimes conflicting) objectives can be given out to players, allowing the group to have intrigue in and amongst their other daily role play options.

Occult (Hidden wisdom) societies:

The Freemasons:

Now, head of the New World Masons, Hiram Abiff stands every morning on the eastern shore of Roanoke island. Every morning he stares out over the water. The Golden Dawn rises every morning. And every morning he looks to the east for any sign of ships. Currently, the head of the Masons of the Old world is a Yeti named Archivist Daysong. He is the Tir na Nog's naturalist and goes by his title of Archivist. His pretense is that he is in search of Bigfoot, and other Arcanian Cryptids.But in actuality, His reasons for traveling to the New World are intentionally obscured.



The Golden Dawn:

No information about the Golden Dawn will appear in print. If you want to be a part of them, too bad. They will recruit on their own, and in secret for their own nefarious plans.



Aristocratic and Philanthropic Orders:

The Knights du Roi Soleil:

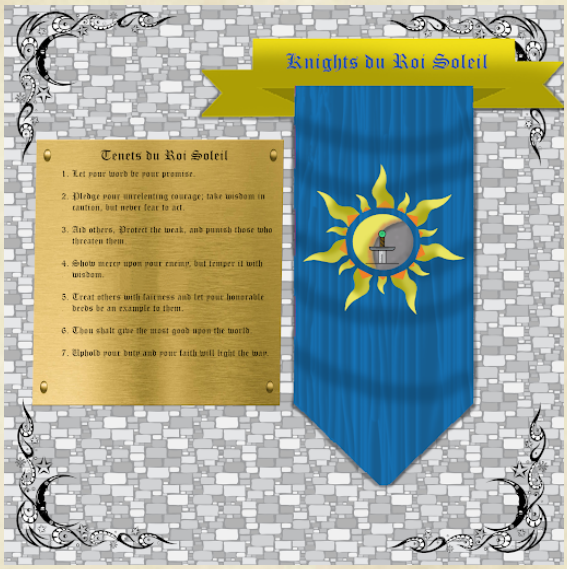
The Knights du Roi Soleil represent everything Arcania fears (whether or not some of their fears maybe misguided if for the players to decide). The will of the gods is vast and varied, but the knights believe that they (the gods) existed to help and guide mortals through life. Giving them strength when they needed it, and hope when they were without it. Somewhere in the cycle of Croatoan years ago, the Day of the Black Sun commenced and all warmth that emanated from Machidiel's power was destroyed. One man's divine oath before all the living gods of good faith ignited a movement and passion inside the founding order: the Knights du Roi Soleil, the sun king.

The Eclipse Knight who began the order has been lost to time, and the oral tradition of his myths and fables. However, his deeds were not forgotten as the Knights spread their ideals through their pure hearts and noble minds into the world. All those who gave their faith to any God of justice or nature could find sanctuary within their walls and a greater purpose within.

The dark days did not cease however, as when tales of a monstrosity so evil had been delivered unto the highest heights of the Celestial mountain palaces of the gods, a great battle took place. The battle of epic proportions could not be contained to that single plane, as the great evil hunger called upon its creations and followers, dividing the gods forces and luring them to the material plane. Catastrophic damage would have been done to all mortals had the gods not brought it to the abyssal Atlantic Ocean. Many gods here suffered casualties of grand proportion. An outcome too costly to be called a victory, for they gave their lives to only delay the inevitable in an unearthly prison, to let its hunger swell to insatiable size.

This pyrrhic success dubbed the Battle of the Atlantic Abyss led for many newer and younger gods to take up the mantle in attempts to guide others and answer upon divine call, however the last battle of the gods solidified the Knights du Roi Soleil's path. It is their belief and practice that through the combined conviction of man and the lost relics of the gods, they can face this ancient evil being and untwist the corrupted souls that follow it.

The code:



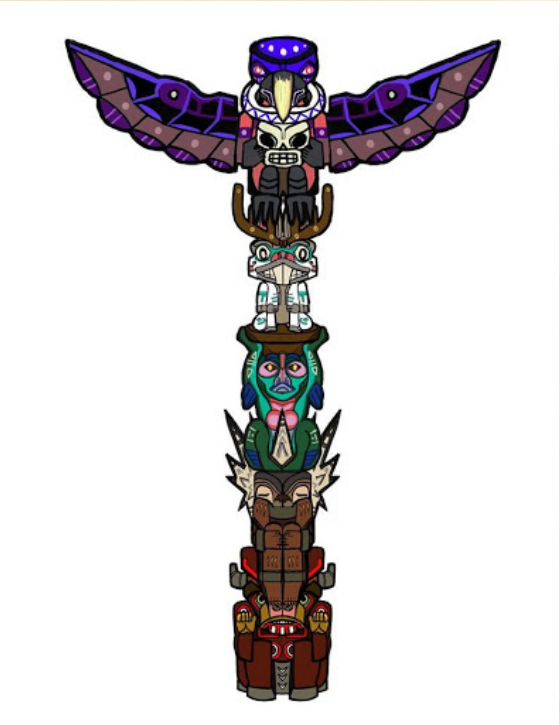
The Order of Kairo:

After the mission from Spain failed to produce a long term foot hold in Arcania, the Spanish crown simply denied that it ever happened. The loved ones of those who disappeared in the mysterious disappearance banded together to seek answers on their own. Kairo, a member of the British Museum has found a way to search for their families while still getting the government to pay for it.

The Origins of the Order of Kairo are shrouded in mystery. It is often believed to be the remnants of an intrepid group of adventurers who were among the first to try to colonize the island of Roanoke. Within the "Legend of Kairo" details are few and often seem incomplete at best, however it is regarded as the apocryphal account of the colonists that witnessed the death and supposed rebirth of one, Kairo the Kenku.



Roanoke Island Lore



Arcania, the New World is a vast and magical place, long sealed off from the Old World by a magical barrier that sheltered it from the influence of divine magic. That Barrier fell during the course of the events of season 2.

Arcania is ruled by four powerful entities known as "Wardens". The wardens are Columbia, Cascadia, Oro and Fontaine and are divided by physical location. Columbia is the Warden of the North East, and her District will one day become the capital of Arcania. Fontaine is the Warden of the South East and makes her home deep in the Floridian jungles.

Roanoke, being set in North Carolina in the 1630's is at a midpoint between Fontaine, the warden of life and Columbia the warden of Justice. They are protectors and patrons of the Arcanian people.

The island itself is populated with 5 playable races:

- **The Urukocra**
  The End of Season 2 left the Uru as a largely untouched feature of the Island. This year they have been far more fleshed out, with their own city and strange politics. The Vulture men of the canopy are by far the most dominant force on the island, seeing their home in roostloft as the highest authority on the island.

- **The Jackalope**
  The End of Season 2 left the whereabouts of the Druid Lich Oleander unaccounted for. He and his Lychwood Treants are nowhere to be seen. The sly and obnoxiously cute vagabonds of the island, Jackalopes live in inaccessible warrens deep below the island.

- **The Chinnokin**
  The End of Season 2 left the Chinnokin in The Salmonfolk are two races that are in conflict this year. They may not be as passive as they have been in past seasons.

- **The Tatankan**
  The end of Season 2 left the fate of the Tatankan people in grave peril. This passive culture was turned to stone with but a single Tatankan left as guardian of the pen. Physically, these are the most imposing people on the island. As herd animals and plainsmen, they are rarely seen alone.

- **The Halfwudgie**
  If the Uru were our Skeksis, then the halfwudgies would be our podlings. Our final race, and the only new race to this year's campaign, the halfwudgies are medium sized humanoids covered in thick brown fur and long quills that can be used as natural weapons.

Week 3 Mayoral Race

Being the Mayor in the game is a special role. Some of our best remembered players and now even one of our DM's have been mayor of Roanoke. The political race lasts one week. Players wishing to through their hat in the ring must be seconded by two of their friends this year. All players participating in the race will be given an opportunity to participate in two town hall style debates with both questions they present and questions taken from the audience. The subject will be "What will our town charter contain?". The elected mayor may then adopt or amend their town charter before signing into law. Debates will be scheduled week 3's wednesday and thursday with voting starting after the main event Thursday and remaining open until Friday after the voice event. All dates and times are scheduled around Pascific Standard Time. (PST is UST-08:00) for our foriegn players.

Combat Field Scholar

Academics, Servants, and Flunkies

Support your Slayer

You have spent your days in service of St. George the Dragon Slayer. And his guild of Combat Field Scholars. The Order's Combat Field Scholars are an organization whose founders were a group of adventurers who famously assisted the slaying of an ancient Green Dragon named Bwytawr ffwl (Fool Eater). Fool Eater was a brutal tyrant prone to cruelty who ruled over several Welsh hamlets with a careless gluttony for their livestock. Desperate to rid his parish of the terrible beast, Saint George turned to the scholars of the land and brought them together to find a way to overcome their oppressor. Famously, they were the first to try to use the Identify spell (a spell with the range “touch”) on a Dragon, in all the known world . Together they stealthily infiltrated his lair and ritually cast for hours while the dragon slept atop his horde pile. Once the knowledge was gained, Saint George himself Slew the wretched monster.

Since then the group has grown. And grown more organized along the way. There was little in their way to hamper their efficacy and self organization. Over time, their ranks began to swell with the clever middlemen content with their comfortable lives but capable of amazing acts of will. The order is a true meritocracy with only the most skilled making the decisions for the group, and the leader passing on their responsibilities when they are surpassed.

Choose one of the Gods of the Round table and work with your DM to detail the nature of your service to the order. Are you a field researcher, or a cloistered scholar? Were you raised amongst the order? Or are you seeking sanctuary within it? Do you have rank within the organization, or are you but a humble monk? Perhaps you came from a village where you were the highest authority, only to find that upon coming to London your reputation isn’t nearly as distinguished as you had thought.

Why be powerful or famous when you can be close to those who are?

Who do you thank or blame for your station in life? Did your mother send you off to the school despite your father's concerns about your scrawny size? Did you get assigned a squireship to keep a king's third son (WULF the half ghast) from any more property damage? Do you sometimes envy the table scraps being given to pampered pets? Did you join because you wanted to be as near to the fame and glory of the most famous knights and nobility as you could? Or did you join in hopes of raising your station in life by catching someone's eye?

Everyone trusts a wellspoken person with a clipboard.

Combat Field Scholars control the infrastructure of London. Despite being a private entity, they are the postal service, the town criers, they are your school masters, they handle the affairs of busy work and steadily entwine the country with silent help. As the country's news source, education, lines of communication, and bureaucracy, the Combat Field Scholars wield a sort of slow, silent pressure that influences so profoundly that no one notices.



Skill Proficiencies: Persuasion and (your choice of) history or religion.
Tool Proficirncies: Dragon chess
Languages: Draconic
Equipment:A holy symbol (a silver necklace depicting Saint George. A scholarly book or hymnal, 5 sticks of incense, scholar’s vestments, a set of common clothes, and a pouch containing 15 sp

Feature: The Meek shall Inherit

Your time spent learning how to squire, scholar and scrub has made you quite handy to have around in most situations. You have become adept at the humble art of please and thank you. As a reaction, you may retry a charisma based skill check that another player has failed. For example, you could use *"Um, Excuse me, but you will have to pardon my friend, could I perhaps be of some assistance?"* or other such humble query when role playing this feature.

Suggested Characteristics:

d8 Traits

1 I value learning more than life.

2 I find that education equalizes the serfs and the aristocracy.

3 I am intolerant of ignorance.

4 It irritates me when things aren't in order.

5 Nothing can shake my optimistic attitude. I quote (*or misquote*) famous naturalists often.

6 The best part of being a scholar is never having to work hard for food.

7 If my supervisor hadn't sent me on this quest, I wouldn't have come.

8 I have spent so much time as a scholar that I have forgotten how to be around people.

d6 Ideals

1 **Nepotism**. My station in life was passed on to me by my parents. One day I will do the same.(Any)

2 **Faith**. Despite the theories of naturalism, my faith in The Gods of the Round table is unshakable.(Lawful)

3 **The Status Quo**. It is not our job to change the world, merely to understand it better.(Neutral)

4 **Knowledge**. The information in a single book is more important to me than any person. (Evil)

5 **Freedom**. Knowledge is the key to elevating yourself. Those who don't seek it, lack it.(Chaotic)

6 **Meritocracy**. Your place in life should be earned, not inherited. What has the king earned? What has a serf, breaking his back in the fields, earned?(Good)

d6 Bonds

1 Someday, I will be a famous scholar.

2 I was left on the order's doorstep as a child.

3 I come from a family of scholars and wish to distinguish myself.

4 I am unsure of the worth of a scholar in the world.

5 Everything I do Is to bring the written word to the masses.

6 I am attempting to finish the world's first Encyclopedia.

d6 Flaws

1 I judge others harshly on their faith.

2 My meekness gets in the way of my goals.

3 I am inflexible in what I believe to be fact.

4 I am in awe of those more physically capable than myself.

5 I can't resist a rare book.

6 Once I decide to study something, I am not easily swayed from my pursuit of it.

Creator's note

The purpose of this document is to provide some backgrounds that are setting appropriate to the colonists of Roanoke. They are not a requirement. More information on 5th edition backgrounds may be found here:ttps://www.d20srd.org/index.htm

The Groundlings of the Globe

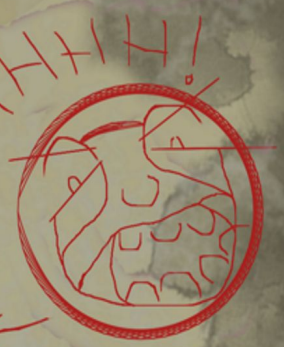
To Our Patron, Lord Chamberlain:

June 29th, 1613 was the day the greatest bardic college in all of England was revealed to be a private spy and smuggler organization run by the ~~nefarious~~ HEROIC Christopher Marlow. Marlow's theater was under protection from the Crown, as it was one of the Queen's favorite forms of entertainment.

Marlow, is now well known to be a master spy and assassin foiled an attempt on the Queen by sabotaging the foreign assassin's plan by setting off explosives as she planted them throughout the building.

WHO

INSERT COMMA







What remains of the building is charred timber and cratered earth. Sincerest apologies for your poodle Persimmon.



From: Lord Chamberlain's Men theater company, former custodians of the crater in the ground which was once your most auspicious creation. The ember of its smouldering ruins will live in our hearts the way the first rays of sun live in the hearts of the young and in-love..

Groundlings of the Globe

To Lord Chamberlain:

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From: The "Lord Chamberlain's Men" theater company, former custodians of the crater in the ground which was once your most auspicious creation. The ember of its smouldering ruins will live in our hearts the way the first rays of sun live in the hearts of the young and in-love.

Perhaps you were there that day. Or perhaps you only say you were. Perhaps you saw as the stagecoach dashed through the city. As Marlow ran across the horses' backs. How he knocked the reins loose and used them to tie the driver's head to the railing. Or perhaps you saw the kitten he caught as it lept from a burning building, and expertly landed into his waiting hat. Either way, as the legend of Marlow grows, so too grow the deeds of the playwrights and minstrels.

Either way,as the legend of Marlow grows, so too grow the deeds of the playwrights and minstrels.

The Groundlings of the Globe

You are one of the few, one of the dedicated suffering artists who is as likely to be paid in stew and ale for his art as he is to play for precious gems and sacks of gold from royalty. The Globe may be burnt to the ground, but the Groundlings of the Globe still live on in every audience member, in every rhyming couplet of iambic pentameter, is every brush stroke and every line penned. To be a Groundling is to accept that you are the master of the Craft that must constantly justify its own existence.

No one says to a carpenter "Show me a new way to build a house." But a musician must constantly learn or write new songs. And a playwright cannot ask his actors to act out the same play everyday for all time. And so, they must continue to invent new worlds and characters to explore. To be a Groundling, you can be anyone one. But to be a true groundling, you cannot be anyone else. Forsake your trade, forsake your inheritance, there is only the spotlight and the knowledge that to chase it is more likely to lead you to ruin than fame. But for the groundlings who stay true through the lean times, there is a bond that is unshakable. The is a consistency of good character and a shared brotherhood between players and artists that cannot be compared. Artists who call themselves groundlings take care of one another, they share when they have nothing to give. And so long as it goes back into raising up the community to be better, they give even more when they have plenty.

Feature: Scribbles for nibbles.

A serf may live as well as a merchant if they secure patronage from an aristocrat. In exchange for a work of art, a play, or some other sort of performance, a Groundling may seek small favors from their patron. Additional help may be bartered if the Aristocrat wishes help in matters of arranging a marriage or a smear campaign to help influence politics. You are headed to the New World. Are you following your patron? Do you want experience to draw from to adapt the story into a book or play? Are you a member of a troop of players (Talk to your DM to see if there are any other Groundlings looking to be part of a shared back story).

Skill Proficiencies: Performance Sleight of Hand

Tool Proficiencies: Any Instrument

Equipment: (choose one)

- Stage makeup, 2 costumes, and a half of a play.
- A quill, ink and 10 sheets of paper and a really great idea for a story.
- An easel, canvas and paint.

Suggested Characteristics

d8 Traits

1 I know a better story than yours..

2 Two eyes, two ears, one mouth. Hear a lot, see a lot, and shut up.

3 I'm a hopeless romantic. I've fallen in love twice since noon.

4 Humor is better than a dagger for revenge

5 I let people see the beauty in the sad moments.

6 I get bitter if I'm not the center of attention.

7 I'm a professional critic of whatever we are doing at the time.

8 My moods run up and down like scales on a child's recorder.

d6 Ideals

1 **Beauty**. When I perform, I try to make the world better than it was. (Good)

2 **Oral Tradition**. They say drunk words are sober thoughts, and our sober thoughts can be heard nightly in the songs of our pubs.

3 **Creativity**. Art is found, not made. Noticing it is your true craft. (Chaotic)

4 **Narcissism**. I adore the theater half as much as it adores me. (Evil)

5 **Patronage**. My success will fund the successes of others.

6 **Honesty**. Part of your craft is the pursuit and unmasking of forgers and plagiarizers (Any)

d6 Bonds

1 My need for attention is the heaviest burden on my mind.

2 I travel with the people most likely to deserve to be immortalized in song.

3 I want to be mobbed by adoring fans.

4 I idolize Marlow and have a list of deeds to accomplish to be even greater than he.

5 A friend of mine and I (shared backstory) play rivals in public, but in truth are good friends.

6 I'm banking good karma now, because I'm scared I may need to spend some later.

d6 Flaws

1 My mind and my talent are my most prized possession. I wouldn't risk my capacity for art for even my closest friends.

2 I'm a sucker for games of chance

3 I can't break character, because I'm method.

4 I'm banned from bristol until futher notice.

5 I have a minor deformity and I'm helping some one woo my crush

6 I stay with the theaters because its comfortable and I'm afraid of success.

The Highgate Hunting Club

Monsterslayers and Safari Hunters

Highgate Cemetery is known as one the Magnificent Seven Cemeteries of London. It is from these majestic hallowed grounds that The Highgate Club takes its name.This well funded group of monster hunters is known through their tales as told in the Strand Magazine, a publication well known for its serial adventures and mysteries. It is chock full of eccentric and wealthy enthusiasts, crackpot theories, doomsday preppers and big game hunters, there is no challenge too dangerous for the Highgate Club.

A Card Carrying Member

As a member of the club, you are likely to adorn any place you live with massive taxidermied monsters and glorious trophies of your hunt, or the hunters that you admire most. Your interactions with the club may be as well (possibly over) armed groups that are each complete with their own themes and dramatic trappings (such as ornate armor or a particular focus on a specific kind of Old World cryptid like vampires or werewolves).

Feature: Ballroom Brawlers

You are in contact with other eccentric members of the club. These people might be associated with the criminal underworld, the rough-and-tumble folk of the streets, or the vain glorious members of high society. This connection comes in the form of a contact in any city you visit, a person who can provide you with advantage on checks related to finding specific types of Monsters (non humanoid Beasts, Monsters, Aberrations and Cryptids)

The first Big Game hunters of The New World

Legends will be told amongst the Highgate Hunters Club for generations of the prowess of those who first dared to face the wild Arcanian Cryptids. After you have determined your character's background, be sure to include a list of goals and aspirations for your expedition into dangerous lands and the savage cryptids that await you. Remember, it's the killing stroke that counts toward personal glory in the Highgate Hunters Club!

Skill proficiencies: Survival, History.
Tool proficiencies: Your choice of one artisan tool.
Languages: Undercommon
Equipment: A utility belt that containes everything you would normally be carying in a dungeoneers kit



Suggested Characteristics

Your bond might involve other hunters or the organizations or individuals that employ you or whom you employee. Your ideal could be associated with your determination to always catch your quarry or your desire to maintain your reputation for being a great monster hunter.

d6 Traits

1 I always have a plan for what to do when things go wrong. My wallet.

2 I am like a leaf on the wind. Always calm and able to change with my circumstances.

3 The first thing I do in a new place is note the locations of every possible threat or weakness.

4 Friendships and camaraderie are more important to me than a successful hunt.

5 A true hunter embodies patience.I can outwait my prey.

6 Having part of a plan is better than no plan. Just, never tell me the odds.

7 Challenging my competency will always result in me needing to prove myself.

8 Despite the many advantages of my lifestyle, I have a very short fuse.

d6 Ideals

1 **Honor.** I take responsibility for the lives that I end and the repercussions of my actions.. (Lawful)

2 **Freedom.** Barstools are meant to be broken, and the best hunts are spontaneous. (Chaotic)

3 **Charity.** I am bringing people into the order so that they may have a place in the world.

4 **Greed.** I hunt monsters for profit. (Evil)(Neutral)

5 **People.** I'm loyal to my friends, everyone else can go cry in a bucket. (Neutral)

6 **Redemption.** I hunt to make up for my own monstrous ways. (Good)

d6 Bonds

1 My obsession with monster hunting has lost me my inheritance. I owe to a generous benefactor.

2 My trophies represent memories of good triumphing over evil.

3 A rival got the kill shot while I was still aiming. I must be a better huntsman.

4 There will never be a greater story or song than the ones that will one day describe my triumphs.

5 I'm a serf who hunts to impress a Noble, be it for gain or love..

6 While the other hunters take risks, I take the time to protect my group members and ensure their success.

d6 Flaw

1 I'm trigger happy, kill it now. Kill it with fire and sticks.

2 I am unable to fund my own activities, so I'm constantly trying to invent things with makeshift materials and roughshod craftsmanship.

3 I'm likely to ignore a plan that I didn't come up with.

4 I never miss a chance to boast or exaggerate.

5 I've never actually killed anything. I just like taxidermy.

6 I pester the others about the morality of their choices while making no qualms about the murders I commit with the other club members.

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The Lazaurian Oath

The Oath

"I will use my mind to restore the health of all creatures with sympathy, compassion, and heedfulness
I will use my hands to be able to prepare medicines well
I will use my eyes to know what medicine is suitable and what is not. I will not give the unsuitable, only the suitable.
I will use my heart to minister to the sick with an attitude of love, not out of desire for gain.
I will use my legs to remain with the sick wherever they are.
I will use my lungs to instruct the novice and bring cheer to the ill.
And when all fails, and death arrives, it is I who will thank him for the peace given unto the wretched."

Your pledge to the Oath of Lazarus is to the Oath and no other. And though many speak for the Oath takers, there is no one who governs you and no code but your own ethics. Those who have taken the Oath refer to themselves as the Afflicted as a mark of humility. You know that identifying with your patient is intended to serve the easing of their pain. You may have taken the oath early, perhaps you were too immature to understand the fullness of the implications of a lifetime of service. That you would take no family but the refugee, the meek and the ill fated.

But with this life comes a level of access not granted to the rest of the world. For upon the battlefields of war and politics there is no shield greater than the healer who bares the traditional cilice upon their leg.This ancient form of self atonement steadys the hand of the surgeon and merchant alike. For though one of the afflicted may hold any station in life, it is considered gravest taboo to refuse to help any who tug at its chain.

> When any oath is made before one of the Gods of the Round Table, it has been decreed by Sir Cai any who are caught breaking it will be punished. Different chapters employ different methods, but discredited, denied treatment, tar and feathered, put on the rack, or even death may be invoked.

Choose a deity in whose name you will take the oath and work with your DM to work out your path amongst the afflicted. Do you wear the Cilice proudly, or have you grown tired of it as it bites its metal teeth into your flesh day after day? Did the order have a hand in raising you, or did you abandon a life of ease to lessen the guilt of a dark burden? Do you run into the fields of war to give succor despite the many dangers, or do you seek out those who hide their pain? While the origins of the Afflicted remain shrouded by the passing of generations, they have served in every conflict, every tragedy, every life in all of the Old World.

Feature: Burden of Life

Choose a deity in whose name you will take the oath and work with your DM to work out your path amongst the afflicted. Do you wear the Cilice proudly, or have you grown tired of it as it bites its metal teeth into your flesh day after day? Did the order have a hand in raising you, or did you abandon a life of ease to lessen the guilt of a dark burden? Do you run into the fields of war to give succor despite the many dangers, or do you seek out those who hide their pain? While the origins of the Afflicted remain shrouded by the passing of generations, they have served in every conflict, every tragedy, every life in all of the Old World.

It is not unreasonable to assume that a guard could look the other way for an offending Afflicted particularly if that guard had ever been previously injured. A barkeep may waive some fees associated with their tavern for an Afflicted in return for dentistry or lancing boils.

Provided their reputation is unsullied and publicly the Oath is held, they may use any medical facility a populace has available (usually a Church, University, or Large Hall) as temporary residence for themselves, their patients, wards and companions (in that order) if there is room for them. Fellow Afflicted are typically civil to one another. And in the few moments they get to stumble across one another, the stories told over a glass of ale to one another are some of the best you will ever hear.

It falls to you, then, to carry the tradition on to the new world.

Specialty d6

1	Diagnostics
2	Apothecary
3	Surgeon
4	Chiropractic
5	Theraputic
6	Research

Skill Proficiencies: Medicine, Insight
Tool Proficiencies: Herbalism Kit, Alchemy Kit
Equipment: a Healer's kit, 2-man tent, bedroll, blanket, Book (About anatomy, disease, apothecary, or surgery), common clothes, five bars of soap, a belt pouch containing 5 gp.



Suggested Characteristics

d6 Personality Trait

1 All I think about is saving lives, or lives that have been lost.

2 I swore the Oath in the name of my religion, nation, or clan.

3 I am cold and calculating in my every word and action, even when furious or frightened.

4 When even the slightest malody or symptom appears, I take immediate action.

5 I consider magical healers and healing either to be cheating and unaccountable, or an integral future counterpart of a greater medical art.

6 I am waging a personal war on death itself.

7 I am entranced and inspired by the brilliance and glory of the living body.

8 I am actively involved in the medical society and engage in theoretical discourse and debate.

d6 Ideals

1 **Life.** I was put on this world to protect and save life (Good)

2 **Duty.** I swore the Oath, and I must live by its tenets. (Lawful)

3 **Vigilantism.** No man can dictate who shall die, when or howl (Chaotic)

4 **Profit.** Is it really my fault that all who come to me suffering also come bearing compensation? (Evil)

5 **Survival.** We are all in this together, for better or for worse. (Neutral)

6 **Right.** Everyone deserves to live. (Neutral)

d6 Bonds

1 I owe everything to my home village/clan, for pooling their resources to have me educated.

2 I was pushed, or encouraged, into taking the oath by my parents.

3 My professor is the most most important person in the world to me.

4 My patients are my everything- losing one of them is like dying, but it never ends.

5 I took up the Oath because someone close to me died of something treatable.

6 I started my training alone from texts I obtained by my own means.

d6 Flaws

1 I took the Oath not realizing its full implications.

2 No one can know that I have broken the Oath.

3 I feel contempt for many of my patients.

4 I think I am better than others in general for taking the Oath.

5 Sometimes I go too far in my search for knowledge.

6 I am frightened/sickened by human suffering.

Creator's note

The purpose of this document is to provide some backgrounds that are setting appropriate to the colonists of Roanoke. They are not a requirement. More information on 5th edition backgrounds may be found here: https://www.d20srd.org/index.htm

The Vigil of Siege Perilous

Before there was England there was the throne. Before the first of the angler tribe departed the main land of the Old World, there was the throne. At the dawning of the dragons, the green and the red, the white and the black laid claim to all of the land. A single gold dragon looked on the isles and wept for their future. And so Merlin the Golden Dragon, and 33rd degree mason, came to Wales. He set the capstone in Cardiff, of what would one day become Camelot. And Upon that place Merlin returned to make a throne for his King. Not the throne he would sit on, but a masonic machine of perfecting justice. The measuring tool upon which good is divided from bad. The Siege Perilous. Those who prefer no uncertain terms in life, rigidity, habit and discipline are likely to belong to a local chapter of the the Siege Perilous.

A Cult of Vigilantism

You believe that the world is clearly and absolutely divided by Good and Evil. And the dividing line between them exacts a toll upon those who live their lives as anything less than good.The vigil of Siege Perilous seeks to safeguard Arthur's kingdom in his absence by deed and song. The deeds done are recorded in a heraldic tome called the **Y brenin unwaith ac yn y dyfodol** (The Once and Future King). Any deed one wishes to record may be inscribed in the tome for a fee of 5 silver pieces. This has made the leadership of the Vigil both rich, and sure of the rightness of their deeds (however correct or misguided they may be). Talk to your DM. Work out where you fit in this rigid religious structure. Are you a shrewd and clever leader ready to lay claim to a mayoral race? or perhaps you are a hedge knight, roaming the king's roads in search of evil to punish. In most small towns a chapter of the Vigil chooses to self police their home and help protect their region against invasion. Were you an upstanding citizen of some hamlet assigned to town defense only to find that after a day's trip to the market, the home you returned to had been sacked by monsters leaving you to seek a new start in the world?

The fate of the New World relies on you

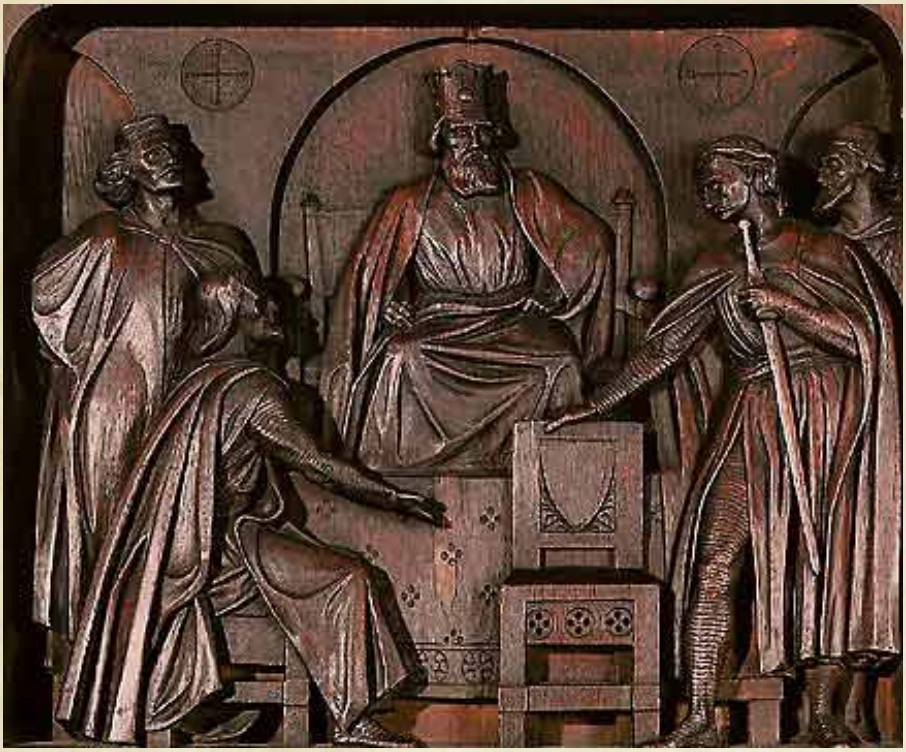
Decide the moral cause you will champion. Chastity, Temperance, Charity, Diligence, Patience, Kindness, or Humility. And a vice you wish to eliminate from the world: Lust, Gluttony, Greed, Sloth, Wrath, Envy, or Pride. Design a character with the two attributes in mind. Perhaps you are of the Charitable Vigil of the Siege Perilous' wrath. Your character would then be pleased by charitable things, and quick to stand between a raging barbarian and his intended foe. Or perhaps your cause is Temperance and the sin you wish to cleanse the world of is lust. You may be a member of the Sober Vigil of the Siege Perilous' harlot. Discuss with your DM what your chosen options do for your lifestyle and RP interactions.

d7	Virtue	d7	Vice
1	Chastity	1	Lust
2	Temperance	2	Gluttony
3	Charity	3	Greed
4	Diligence	4	Sloth
5	Patience	5	Wrath
6	Kindness	6	Envy
7	Humility	7	Pride

Feature: Arbiter

Most rural leadership rely on Vigils to keep the peace. In times of minor conflict most peasants will trust a Vigil member to settle their agreements fairly and without bias.The traditional payment for such an arbitration is 5 gold, as decreed by a clever bard's song many years ago.The symbol of the vigil is the manacles. And a member is never without them in case a threat presents itself.

Skill proficiencies: Intimidation, Insight.
Tool proficiencies: Calligraphy set. A Viol.
Languages: Dwarvish



Suggested Characteristics

d8 Traits

1 It is not permissible for me to allow my judgment become confused by emotion.

2 I have very limited patience for the bureaucracy I'm forced to deal with every day.

3 I am slow to speak, but I expect it to listened to

4 People find me messy, but there is an order to my chaos.

5 I rank my friends in order of usefulness.

6 I cannot abide anyone who does not directly say what they mean.

7 The way I care for others is by caring about what laws are passed.

8 I use my skills as a lobbyist to persuade others regularly.

d6 Ideals

1 **The Siege.** Finding someone worthy of the seat is all that really matters.(Chaotic)

2 **Order.** The law is meant to ensure Arthur's kingdom while he is away.(Lawful)

3 **Peace.** The ultimate objective of the violence of Siege Perilous is to remove violence from society.(Good)

4 **Recognition.** No deed should be kept from the siege, Good or Evil. All must be recorded. My deeds are sure to be rewarded.(Neutral)

5 **Punishment** A public display of consequences is the model for how to deal with those who cross us.(Evil)

6 **Legislation.** The laws that guide the country must be cared for by those devoted to our cause.(Any)

d6 Bonds

1 I failed to give justice to a criminal once. Their subsequent costly betrayal has boosted my thirst for justice.

2 I wish to write the laws, not just enforce them.

3 Despite the rigours code of the Siege, I believe mercy is Arthur's will.

4 I successfully convicted a murder who later escaped my judgment. I still seek them.

5 I long to sit in Arthur's chair once I have proved my worth.

6 I've modeled my career after a highly respected Arbiter who convicted my mother for crimes against our King.

d6 Flaws

1 I'm incapable of recognizing deception.

2 I seem like a harsh judge to others, but I judge myself most harshly of all.

3 I have broken the law and am aware that I am eluding justice.

4 I was traumatized by being forced to commit a crime as a child.

5 I'm unable to distinguish between the letter and the spirit of the law.

6 I wish I had joined the siege publicly, but I fear they'd never accept me.

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